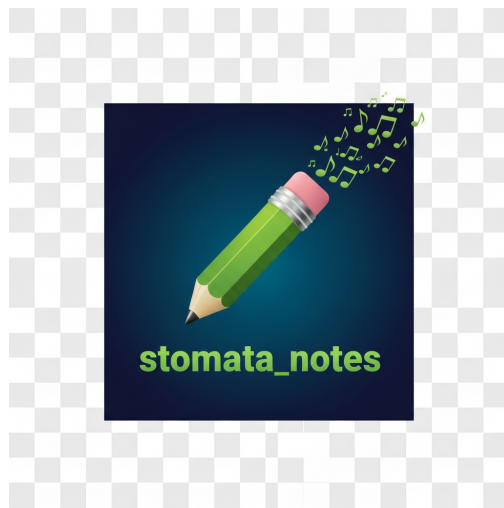




stomata_notes

Hierarchical Notes for REAPER

BETA

User Documentation

Version 0.9.1

A centralized note-taking panel for REAPER that stores notes at five independent levels — Global, Project, Track, Item, and FX — so your session knowledge is always one click away.

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1. Overview

stomata_notes is a REAPER script that adds a floating notes panel to your DAW session. Rather than keeping one big text document, it organises your notes into five contextual levels so the right note is always visible for whatever you are currently working on.

Notes are stored natively inside the REAPER project file (*.RPP*) wherever possible, meaning they travel with the project and appear in REAPER's own Track Properties and Item Properties dialogs. Global notes live in a single text file in the REAPER resource folder, making them available across every project. Plain-text sidecar files are also written to a `stomata_notes/` subfolder next to the project so notes can be read without opening REAPER.

Note levels at a glance

Feature	Description
Global	Cross-project notes. Saved to a plain .txt file in the REAPER resource path. Visible regardless of which project is open.
Project	Per-project notes. Stored in REAPER's native Project Notes (View > Project Notes) and in ProjExtState as a fallback.
Track	One note per track. Stored in the track's native P_NOTES field (visible in Track Properties) and mirrored to a sidecar file.
Item	One note per media item. Stored in the item's native P_NOTES field (visible in Item Properties) and mirrored to a sidecar file.
FX	One note per FX slot, keyed to the FX chain index. Stored as P_EXT metadata on the parent track inside the .RPP file.

2. Requirements

stomata_notes has a single external dependency: the **RealmGui** extension, which provides the Dear ImGui bindings used to draw the floating panel. Everything else is bundled with REAPER.

Feature	Description
REAPER	Any recent version (6.x or later recommended).
RealmGui	Required. Install via ReaPack (see Section 3).
ReaPack	Required only for the RealmGui installation step.

Feature	Description
SWS Extension	Optional but recommended. Enables the 'Visit Website' button in the About dialog to open URLs in your default browser. Without it the URL is copied to the clipboard instead. Install from https://www.sws-extension.org/
OS	macOS, Windows, or Linux — all three are supported.

3. Installation

3.1 Install ReaPack

ReaPack is a package manager for REAPER extensions and scripts. If you have not installed it yet, follow these steps:

1. Go to <https://reapack.com> and download the plugin for your operating system.
2. Place the downloaded file (*reaper_reapack.dylib* on macOS, *reaper_reapack64.dll* on Windows, or the Linux equivalent) into your REAPER **UserPlugins** folder. You can open this folder from REAPER via *Options > Show REAPER resource path in explorer/finder*.
3. Restart REAPER. A new **Extensions > ReaPack** menu will appear.

3.2 Install RealmGui via ReaPack

stomata_notes requires the RealmGui extension to render its user interface. Install it through ReaPack:

1. In REAPER, go to **Extensions > ReaPack > Browse packages...**
2. In the search box, type **RealmGui**.
3. Right-click the *RealmGui: ReaScript binding for Dear ImGui* entry and choose **Install** (or **Install version...** for a specific release).
4. Click **Apply**, then **OK**.
5. REAPER will prompt you to restart. Restart to activate RealmGui.

■ *Tip: You can verify RealmGui is installed by opening **Extensions > ReaPack > Manage repositories...** and checking the **Installed Packages** list.*

3.3 Install stomata_notes

stomata_notes is a single Lua script file. No installer is required.

1. Copy **stomata_notes.lua** to your REAPER **Scripts** folder (inside the REAPER resource path).
2. In REAPER, open **Actions > Action list...** (shortcut: ?).
3. Click **New action... > Load ReaScript...** and navigate to *stomata_notes.lua*.
4. Optionally, assign a keyboard shortcut or toolbar button to the action for quick access.
5. Run the action once to confirm the panel opens correctly.

If the script cannot find RealmGui it will display an error message with instructions. Re-check Section 3.2 if this happens.

3.4 File locations after installation

Feature	Description
stomata_notes.lua	REAPER Scripts folder (wherever you placed it).
stomata_notes_global.txt	REAPER resource path root — cross-project Global notes.
stomata_notes/ folder	Created automatically beside the .RPP project file on first save. Contains per-project .txt sidecar files for each note level.
stomata_watcher.ps1	Windows only — temporary PowerShell helper written to the resource path when an external editor session is active. Removed automatically.

4. Opening the Panel

Run the stomata_notes action from the REAPER Action list, a toolbar button, or the keyboard shortcut you assigned during installation. The panel opens as a floating window that can be resized and repositioned anywhere on screen. REAPER will remember its position between sessions.

The panel opens automatically on the most contextually relevant tab: if an FX window is focused it opens on the FX tab; if a media item is selected it opens on the Item tab; if a track is selected it opens on the Track tab; otherwise it defaults to the Project tab.

5. The Interface

The panel is divided into three areas: a **menu bar** at the top, a **toolbar row** with the main action buttons, and a **tab bar** that switches between the five note levels.

5.1 Menu bar

Feature	Description
File › Save Current Tab	Saves the note on the currently visible tab immediately.
File › Save All	Saves all tabs that have unsaved changes.
File › Delete Note	Permanently deletes the current note (see Section 5.4).
File › About Stomata Notes	Opens the About dialog with version, build, and website link (see Section 5.5).
File › Close	Closes the panel (unsaved changes are saved automatically).
Jump To ›	Switches directly to any of the five note tabs. Project-scoped tabs (Project, Track, Item, FX) are greyed out and unclickable when the project is unsaved — see Section 5.6.

5.2 Toolbar buttons

Feature	Description
+ New Note	Clears the editor for the active tab so you can start a fresh note. For Track / Item / FX tabs you must have a selection first.
Save	Saves the current tab. The button is dim grey when there is nothing to save, and glows amber when unsaved changes exist.
Open in Editor	Writes the current note to an RTF file and opens it in your system default text editor (TextEdit on macOS, WordPad on Windows, xdg-open on Linux). Changes are detected live and synced back into REAPER automatically. The button label changes to ★ Live while a file is being watched.
★ Live	Shown in place of 'Open in Editor' while an external editor session is active. Click it to stop watching the file (the editor remains open but changes will no longer sync).
unsaved changes	A dim status hint that appears to the right of the Save button whenever the current tab has edits that have not yet been written to disk.

5.3 Tab bar

Click any tab name to switch to that note level. A small dot appears on a tab label when it has unsaved changes (UnsavedDocument indicator). The active tab label is highlighted in black on a white background.

Double-clicking a Track, Item, or FX tab forces the *list view* for that level, showing all notes that exist in the current project — even when something is already selected.

5.4 Delete Note

Found under **File > Delete Note**, this action permanently removes the note for the currently selected level and context. It does the following in order:

- Shows a **Yes / No confirmation dialog** before doing anything. Choosing No cancels the operation with no changes made.
- Removes the **.rtf** working-copy file for the current tab from the `stomata_notes/` folder (if it exists).
- Removes the **.txt** plain-text sidecar for the same note.
- Stops any active external editor watch for that tab.
- Clears the in-memory editor buffer so the tab shows empty immediately.
- Writes an empty string back to the embedded REAPER storage (Project Notes, P_NOTES, or P_EXT) so the deletion persists when the tab is next loaded.

■ *Deletion is permanent and cannot be undone via REAPER's Undo history. The on-disk files are removed immediately.*

5.5 About Stomata Notes

Accessible from **File > About Stomata Notes**, this modal dialog shows the script version, build number, and the Stomata Audio website URL. It contains three buttons:

Feature	Description
Visit Website	Opens https://stomataaudio.com/ in your default web browser using the SWS extension (CF_ShellExecute). If SWS is not installed, the URL is automatically copied to the clipboard and a message box informs you.
Copy Link	Copies https://stomataaudio.com/ to the clipboard without opening a browser.
Close	Dismisses the dialog and returns to the main panel.

■ *Tip: Install the SWS Extension to enable one-click website access from the About dialog. Download it free from <https://www.sws-extension.org/>*

5.6 Unsaved Project — Global Only Mode

`stomata_notes` writes sidecar files into a `stomata_notes/` subfolder next to the project file. If the project is untitled or has no dedicated project folder, that path does not exist and the script would be forced to write orphaned files into REAPER's resource folder under the generic name `unnamed_*` — cluttering the resource directory and colliding across sessions.

To prevent this, `stomata_notes` enters **Global Only mode** whenever the project is untitled or unsaved. In this mode:

- Only the **Global tab** is accessible. The Project, Track, Item, and FX tabs are greyed out and cannot be clicked.
- The **Jump To** menu greys out the four project-scoped tab names.

- A **yellow warning banner** appears inside the panel explaining why the tabs are locked and what to do.
- On first launch in a locked session, a **startup dialog** explains the situation and gives step-by-step instructions for saving the project.
- The lock **clears automatically** — the moment you save the project with a name and a dedicated subdirectory, all tabs unlock live without needing to reopen the panel.
- If a project becomes unsaved again (e.g. after *File > New Project*), the panel automatically switches back to the Global tab and re-locks the other four.

*To unlock all tabs: save the project via **File > Save Project As...** and ensure **Create subdirectory for project** is checked so the project has its own folder. The tabs activate immediately.*

6. Note Levels in Detail

6.1 Global tab

The Global tab contains a single note that is shared across all REAPER projects. Use it for information that is always relevant, such as studio configuration, preferred signal chains, client contact details, or personal shorthand.

The note is stored as a plain text file at:

```
[REAPER resource path]/stomata_notes_global.txt
```

The file includes a *Last updated* timestamp on the first line that is rewritten automatically on every save. The timestamp is stripped from the edit buffer so it never appears in the editor.

When **Open in Editor** is used on the Global tab, an RTF working-copy is written alongside the canonical .txt file at:

```
[REAPER resource path]/stomata_notes_global.rtf
```

The .txt file remains the authoritative store and is always kept up to date. The .rtf is the rich working copy used during external editing sessions, exactly as with the other tabs.

6.2 Project tab

The Project tab shows notes for the currently loaded REAPER project. The project name is displayed in small grey text above the editor as a reminder of which project you are editing.

Notes are written to REAPER's native **Project Notes** field, which means they are visible in *View > Project Notes* without opening stomata_notes. A copy is also stored in ProjExtState as a safety fallback.

6.3 Track tab

The Track tab displays the note for the currently selected track. The track name appears above the editor. Notes are stored in the track's native **P_NOTES** field, which is the same field shown in *Track Properties*, so changes appear in both places.

When no track is selected, the tab shows a **list view** of all tracks in the project that have notes. Click a track in the list to read or edit its note. Double-click the Track tab heading to return to the list view even when a track is selected.

A plain-text sidecar is also written to the `stomata_notes/` folder beside the project file, named using the project name and track number (e.g. `MyProject_track_03_Drums.txt`).

6.4 Item tab

The Item tab works identically to the Track tab but targets the currently selected media item. The take name is shown above the editor. Notes are stored in the item's native **P_NOTES** field (also visible in *Item Properties*).

The list view shows all items in the project that have notes, labelled as *TrackName > ItemName [m:ss.xx]* so you can quickly locate items by position.

Sidecar filenames include the take name and the item's position in seconds (e.g. `MyProject_item_4.20_Lead_Vox.txt`).

6.5 FX tab

The FX tab attaches a note to a specific FX slot. It tracks whichever FX window was most recently focused in REAPER — the plugin name and parent track name are shown above the editor.

FX notes are stored as **P_EXT** metadata on the parent track inside the `.RPP` file, keyed by FX slot index. They are therefore project-specific and travel with the project file.

The list view shows all FX slots across the entire project — including the Master track — that have notes, displayed as *TrackName > [slot] FXName*.

■ FX note linking is index-based. If you reorder the FX chain after writing a note, the note will follow the original slot position, not the plugin name.

7. Editing Notes

7.1 In-app editor

Each tab uses a two-mode editor: a **read view** that wraps text to the available width, and an **edit view** that accepts keyboard input.

Feature	Description
Click anywhere in the note area	Activates edit mode. Keyboard focus moves to the text field.
Click outside the text field	Returns to read / word-wrap view.
Tab key (in edit mode)	Inserts a tab character (standard indentation).

Feature	Description
All standard text editing keys	Cut, copy, paste, undo (within the session), arrow navigation, Home/End, etc.

7.2 External editor

Click **Open in Editor** to open the current note in your system's default rich-text application — TextEdit on macOS, WordPad on Windows, or the xdg-open handler on Linux.

The note is written to an **RTF file** in the stomata_notes/ folder. stomata_notes then watches the file for changes while the editor is open:

- Edits are detected within a few seconds and synced back into REAPER automatically.
- When you close the document window, a final sync captures any last changes.
- The in-app editor is disabled while an RTF file exists for that tab — all editing must be done externally. This prevents conflicts.
- To return to in-app editing, delete the corresponding RTF file from the stomata_notes/ folder and reopen the script.

■ *The Global tab uses an .rtf working copy for external editing just like the other tabs. The canonical store remains the plain stomata_notes_global.txt file, which is always kept current and is human-readable without any special software.*

8. Saving

stomata_notes saves notes to REAPER's project data. Every save also marks the project as dirty so REAPER's own Save prompt will capture any changes and so the action can be undone via Edit > Undo.

Feature	Description
Auto-save on tab switch	When you click away from a tab that has unsaved changes, those changes are saved before the new tab loads.
Auto-save on close	Closing the panel (× button, File > Close, or the REAPER session ending) saves all dirty tabs automatically.
Manual save	Click the Save button or use File > Save Current Tab / Save All at any time.
External editor auto-save	Changes detected in the watched RTF file are saved immediately to the REAPER project without any manual action.

Each save writes a timestamped copy of the note to a plain-text sidecar file in stomata_notes/. These files are human-readable without REAPER and can be committed to version control alongside your project.

9. List View and Search

The Track, Item, and FX tabs each have a list view that appears automatically when nothing is selected in REAPER. You can also force the list view by double-clicking the tab heading.

At the top of the list is a **Filter** field. Typing in it instantly hides any entries whose label or note text does not contain the search string (case-insensitive). Clear the field to show all notes again.

Clicking a row in the list switches the tab to show that specific note in the editor, even if it belongs to a different track or item than what is currently selected in REAPER. The selection lock is released automatically the moment you click a new track/item in REAPER.

10. Tips and Workflow

Keyboard shortcut

Assign a memorable shortcut (e.g. **Alt+N**) to the `stomata_notes` action in the REAPER Action list. The panel remembers its last position and size so it opens exactly where you left it.

Toolbar button

Right-click any REAPER toolbar and choose *Customize toolbar....* Find the `stomata_notes` action and drag it onto the toolbar. Adding a custom icon (16×16 PNG) is optional but makes it easier to spot at a glance.

Using the Global tab as a cheat sheet

The Global tab is ideal for session-independent reference material: your studio patch bay routing, common plugin preset names, client contact numbers, or any shorthand you use across projects. Because it is stored outside the project file it is always available regardless of which session is loaded.

Pairing Project notes with Track notes

Use the **Project** tab for session-level context — delivery specs, revision history, or overall mix direction — and the **Track** tab for per-track details such as recording chain, tuning, or editing decisions. Because Track notes are visible in Track Properties, collaborators using the same project file will see them even without `stomata_notes` installed.

FX chain documentation

Click an FX window to focus it, then switch to the FX tab and document the plugin's settings, the reason you chose it, or notes about recall. This is particularly useful for hardware emulation plugins where re-creating a sound requires knowing the original context.

Version control

The stomata_notes/ folder contains human-readable .txt sidecar files for every note. Add this folder to your Git or Dropbox sync to track note history alongside your project.

11. Troubleshooting

Feature	Description
"RealmGui extension not found"	Install RealmGui via ReaPack (see Section 3.2) and restart REAPER before running the script.
Panel does not open	Check that the action ran without error (open the REAPER Console via Help > Show REAPER console). A Lua error here usually means a missing dependency.
Project / Track / Item / FX tabs are greyed out	The project is untitled or has no project folder. Save the project via File > Save Project As... with 'Create subdirectory for project' checked. The tabs unlock automatically (see Section 5.6).
Notes not saving	Ensure the project has been saved at least once so REAPER knows the project path. Unsaved projects cannot write sidecar files.
"No selection for this level"	You clicked Open in Editor on the Track, Item, or FX tab with no selection. Select a track/item or focus an FX window first.
External editor opens but changes don't sync	The file watcher relies on OS-level file polling. Confirm the stomata_notes/ folder is not on a read-only or network drive with delayed writes.
In-app editor is greyed out / disabled	An RTF file exists for that tab. Delete the .rtf file from stomata_notes/ and reopen the script to return to in-app editing.
FX note points to wrong plugin	FX notes are keyed by slot index, not plugin name. Reordering the FX chain shifts the indices. Re-assign notes after reordering.
Windows: PowerShell error on Open in Editor	The script writes a temporary .ps1 helper to the REAPER resource path. Ensure your user account has write access to that folder and that PowerShell execution policy allows local scripts.

12. Quick Reference Card

Cut this page out and keep it by your workstation.

Feature	Description
Open / close panel	Run the stomata_notes action (keyboard shortcut or toolbar).

Feature	Description
Switch tabs	Click tab, or use Jump To menu.
Edit a note	Click anywhere in the note area to activate the editor.
Save current tab	Save button (amber = unsaved) or File > Save Current Tab.
Save everything	File > Save All.
New blank note	+ New Note button.
Delete current note	File > Delete Note — asks for confirmation, then permanently removes .rtf and .txt files and clears embedded REAPER note.
Open in external editor	Open in Editor button.
Stop external editor watch	Click ★ Live button.
See all notes for a level	Double-click the Track / Item / FX tab heading.
Search notes	Filter field at the top of the list view.
Find a tab quickly	Menu bar > Jump To > .
Undo a save	Edit > Undo in REAPER (every save creates an undo point).
About / version info	File > About Stomata Notes.